

CONTRACT-TO-CASH TRANSFORMATION

Lean Six Sigma | Contract Operations | Salesforce + FinancialForce / Certinia | API Governance

Representative professional case study. Company, customer, employee, pricing, and other identifying information is redacted or generalized. Detailed financial and rate data in supporting demonstrations is simulated or anonymized. This is not an original employer document.

Executive Summary

Contract and project financial management depended on disconnected sources, manual handoffs, spreadsheets, tribal knowledge, and customer-specific processes. Contract and task-order data, labor categories, rates, time entry, billing, and collections did not operate from one governed source of truth. The transformation used Lean Six Sigma process analysis to define a more linear, controlled operating model supported by Salesforce and FinancialForce / Certinia.

~4 weeks	5 days	Integrated
Baseline invoice + timesheet review cycle	Documented end-state turnaround	Contract-to-billing management view

My Role

I led the business-process side of the transformation across Contracts/PMO, IT, Services Delivery, and Finance. My work included mapping the current state, identifying Lean Six Sigma gaps and control failures, translating contract and billing requirements into system fields and workflows, partnering with internal and external developers, defining UAT scenarios, validating reporting, and helping establish the governance needed for production use.

The Current-State Problem

Process area	Representative current-state workflow
Contract / task order intake	Email/fax, verbal PO, EDI order
Rate management	Data Cube 1, team tracker, PMO listing, QuickBooks
Operating knowledge	Tribal knowledge
Timesheet entry	Manual customer spreadsheet and proprietary customer-specific systems
Review / approval	Project Manager -> Service Delivery Manager -> Project Manager -> Finance
Billing preparation	Manual QuickBooks upload -> QC export -> corrections -> billing-file upload
Collections	Manual QuickBooks reporting

Lean Six Sigma / DMAIC Approach

DEFINE	Document the contract-to-cash problem, stakeholders, control requirements, and desired business outcome.
MEASURE	Establish the current-state cycle and identify where active work was separated by waiting, reconciliation, corrections, and handoffs.
ANALYZE	Map waste and failure points: missing time, inconsistent rate/LCAT mapping, duplicate entry, manual reconciliation, unclear ownership, and limited funding visibility.
IMPROVE	Define contract, task-order, LCAT, rate, time-entry, billing, and reporting requirements; translate them into Salesforce + FinancialForce / Certinia workflows; test representative scenarios through UAT.
CONTROL	Establish required fields, validation, exception reporting, RACI ownership, API-interface testing, reconciliation controls, and executive KPIs.

Future-State Operating Model

Contract / TO	-	Pricing & LCAT	-	Time & Validation	-	Billing / A/R	-	Reporting
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Salesforce provides the contract/customer and task-order structure. FinancialForce / Certinia supports professional-services time, billing, and related operational data. Integration and controls connect the workflow while preserving appropriate financial-system responsibilities.

Governance & Control Design

- Contract and task-order field design with governed ownership.
- LCAT, bill-rate, actual-rate, and margin controls with restricted financial data.
- Funding, invoiced, paid, remaining-funds, billing-variance, missing-time, and A/R visibility.
- UAT scenarios, negative testing, and exception handling.
- IT/API RACI covering mapping, authentication, payload validation, billing-event transfer, reconciliation, logging, and go-live readiness.
- Production-readiness criteria requiring unresolved high-risk defects to be addressed before go-live.

Control Failure Identified During Validation

As contract data was loaded and validated, missing timesheets were identified. That visibility triggered an internal self-audit comparing project delivery, billable activity, invoices, collections, and remaining funding. The project manager was given an opportunity to correct the records with follow-up check-ins; outstanding invoices and approximate funding burndown were recalculated; and a customer payment/funding process was negotiated because responsibility for project management was shared.

Business Outcome

Invoice creation plus timesheet review and acceptance improved from approximately four weeks to approximately five days.

The redesigned approach also improved management visibility into task-order funding, approved versus billed work, remaining funding, billing variance, missing time, and outstanding A/R.

Supporting Portfolio Evidence

A sanitized Contract-to-Cash workbook supports this case study. It is intentionally maintained outside the public GitHub repository and can be shared directly during an interview or upon request.

Workbook view	What it demonstrates
TO Tracking	Funding, invoiced, paid, remaining funding, missing hours, and billing variance by task order / LCAT.
Executive Dashboard	Portfolio-level funding, billing, A/R, variance, missing-time, and cycle-time visibility.
Process Map	Current-state fragmentation and the future-state integrated data flow.
UAT	Representative testing of required fields, reports, workflow, and exception scenarios.
Field Design	Contract, task-order, labor-category, rate, actual-rate, profit, and control-field requirements.
IT API RACI	Interface ownership, negative testing, reconciliation, and production-readiness decisions.
Kaizen Data Flow	Input source, owner, waste/problem, future system, future owner, automation, and control outcome.

Skills Demonstrated

Contract Lifecycle Management • Post-Award Operations • PMO • Lean Six Sigma • Kaizen • Process Mapping • Salesforce • FinancialForce / Certinia • UAT • API Governance • RACI • Financial Controls • Executive Reporting • Risk & Exception Management

Sharing note: The PDF is the quick-review case study. The sanitized Excel workbook is the deeper supporting sample. Editable working files, prior versions, customer information, employee information, and unredacted artifacts are not part of the external package.